



NORWAY

Capital city: Oslo

Area: 125,181 sq miles
(324,220 sq km)

Population: 4,233,116

Official language:
NorwegianMajor religions: Christian
90%, other 10%Government: Multiparty
democracyCurrency: Norwegian
krone

Adult literacy rate: 99%

Life expectancy: 79 years

People per doctor: 333

Televisions: 579 per
1,000 people

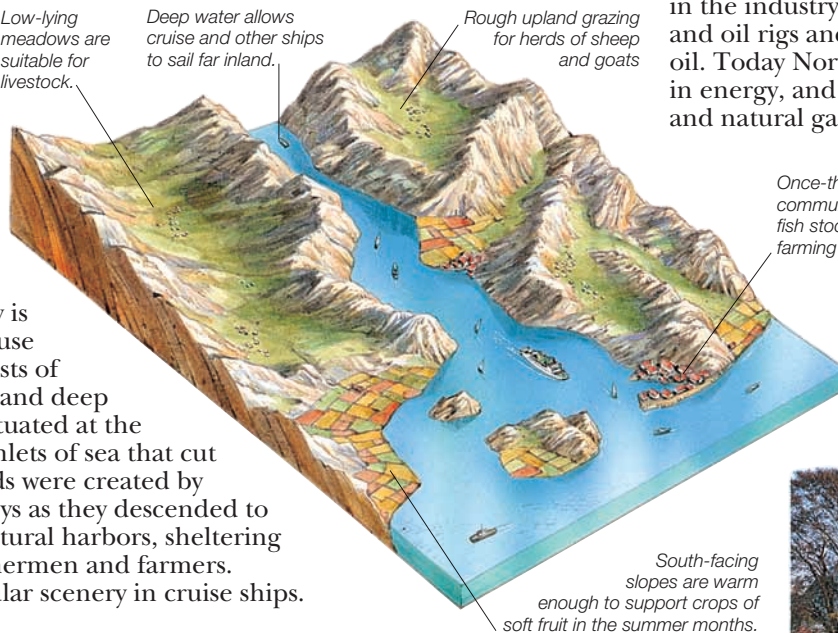
NORWAY

NORWAY LIES ALONG the western coast of Scandinavia. It is a long country, narrow in its northern half and only 50 miles (80 km) wide at one point. Despite its northerly location, Norway's lengthy coastline is kept free of ice by the warm Gulf Stream. Most of the country is mountainous, with spectacular landscapes of thousands of lakes and offshore islands. Many people work in industry, including offshore oil and gas production, shipbuilding, and mining. Fishing, forestry, and agriculture employ only about five percent of the total workforce.

Low-lying meadows are suitable for livestock.

Deep water allows cruise and other ships to sail far inland.

Rough upland grazing for herds of sheep and goats



Once-thriving coastal fishing communities are declining as fish stocks diminish, but fish farming is increasing.

FJORDS

Only 3 percent of Norway is suitable for farming because most of the country consists of rugged mountain ranges and deep lakes. Most farmland is situated at the head of fjords, the long inlets of sea that cut into Norway's coast. Fjords were created by glaciers gouging out valleys as they descended to the sea. The fjords are natural harbors, sheltering small communities of fishermen and farmers. Tourists visit the spectacular scenery in cruise ships.

SHIPPING

Norway has one of the largest shipping fleets in the world. Many thousands of people are employed in shipyards and repair docks and on board the many merchant ships and ferries that supply the ports and islands of the west coast. The most important port is the capital city, Oslo. Over half a million people live in this bustling, lively city, which is the cultural, intellectual, and industrial center of the country.



OIL INDUSTRY

The discovery of oil and gas under the North Sea in 1969 transformed the Norwegian economy, turning the country into Europe's largest oil producer. Thousands of people work in the industry, constructing tankers and oil rigs and refining the crude oil. Today Norway is self-sufficient in energy, and exports most of its oil and natural gas to the rest of Europe.

Traditional stave church in Sogne Fjord



WOODEN CHURCHES

Ancient stave churches are found throughout Norway. Unlike log cabins, which are made of horizontal logs, stave churches are built with vertical, curved strips of wood called staves. Not a single nail is used in the construction, which is powerful enough to withstand heavy winter snowfalls.



SKIING

Norway is the home of skiing. The earliest remains of skis were found in a glacier here, and the word "ski" is of Norwegian origin. During the snowy winter months, the most efficient way for many Norwegians to travel is on skis. A ski jump is a feature of most towns in Norway. Annual ski festivals are popular, as is the sport of cross-country skiing.

Find out more

GAS: 163, 198, 211
GLACIERS: 79
GULF STREAM: 76
OIL: 152, 281